GUIDELINES FOR ASSESSING VITAL SIGNS

- The nurse caring for the patient is responsible for assessing vital signs.
- The nurse should obtain the vital signs, interpret their significance and make decisions about interventions.
- Equipment used to measure vital signs must work properly to ensure accurate finding.
- Equipment should be selected based on the client's condition and characteristics.
- The nurse controls or minimizes environmental factors that may affect vital signs.
- The nurse uses an organized, systematic approach when taking vital signs. Each procedure requires a step – by – step approach to ensure accuracy.
- The manner of approach to the patient can alter the vital signs. The nurse should approach the patient in a calm caring manner while taking vital signs.
- Based on patient's condition, the nurse collaborates with the physician to decide the frequency of vital signs assessment.
- The nurse analyzes the results of vital signs measurement. The nurse is often in the best position to assess all clinical finding about a patient.
- Vital signs are documented and communicated to the nurse assuming care of the patient and well as patient.

6.6.1 Temperature

Normal body temperature varies by person, age, activity, and time of day. The average normal body temperature isgenerallyaccepted as 98.6°F (37°C).

Physiology of body temperature

The body temperature is precisely regulated by physiological and behavioral mechanisms. For body temperature to stay constant and with normal range, the relationship between heat production and heat loss must be maintained.

Body temperature undergoes minor changes throughout the day. It is the lowest in the morning, between 4 and 6 a.m. and highest in the evening, around 6 to 8 p.m.

Body temperature is the balance between heat loss and heat production.

Range of Normal Temperature				
°F	0–2 Years	3–10 Years	11–65 Years	>65 Years
Oral	–	95.9–99.5	97.6–99.6	96.5–98.5
Rectal	97.9–100.4	97.9–100.4	98.6–100.6	97.1–99.2
Axillary	94.5–99.1	96.6–98.0	95.3–98.4	96.0–97.4
Ear	97.5–100.4	97.0–100.0	96.6–99.7	96.4–99.5
Groin	97.5–100.0	97.5–100.0	98.2–100.2	96.6–98.8

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